

with which software releases took place. New innovations and improvements were constantly being made to the browser and that made it “the” browser to browse the Internet with. Newer HTML capabilities were added with every release to Netscape and in most cases, these enhancements and improvements were much, much better than any other browser could provide at that time. By the summer of 1995, it was a good bet that if you were browsing the Internet, you were doing so with a Netscape browser—by some accounts Netscape had over 80 per cent market share, and Netscape’s browser helped cement their own dominance.

Enter Windows 95 and Internet Explorer, and Netscape met with their first worthy competitor. Microsoft made Operating Systems for a living, and browsers were a spin-off from the OS. For sometime though, Internet Explorer played second fiddle to Netscape and was always playing catch up. There were two advantages that Netscape could not deny that Microsoft had. First that Microsoft was way above Netscape in terms of market penetration, and secondly, Internet Explorer was free while Netscape was not.

Netscape wanted to counter this situation in a manner that would impress its clients and in March 1996 launched Netscape 2. With the launch of Netscape 2 a bevy of must-have breakthrough features (frames, Java, Javascript and Plug-ins) which helped distance it from the pack. To counter the “free” Internet Explorer browser issue, Netscape gave it away for free to carefully selected target audiences, such as students and teachers which helped immeasurably to spread the word and to ensure Netscape’s dominance.

Netscape 3 rolled out in August 96 at almost the same time as Internet Explorer 3.0 and this flared off a war amongst the two mammoths. Although, Netscape was still the dominant one in the browser market, Internet Explorer by then started making their first dents in the browser market and eating into the Netscape pie.